

Texas WIC

Health and Human Services Commission

Effective April 1, 2026

Policy CS:25.0(eWIC)

Documentation of Food Benefits and the Assignment of Texas WIC Cards

Purpose

To ensure a record for food benefits is assigned by the Local Agency (LA) to the Electronic Benefit Account (EBA) and the assignment of the Texas WIC card are documented in the MIS.

Authority

7 CFR Part 246.7

Policy

The local agency (LA) must assign one Texas WIC Card to each economic unit and ensure that food benefits are correctly loaded to the Electronic Benefit Account (EBA). The MIS will aggregate food benefits for all participants within an economic unit and will not allow issuance for past benefit months.

Definitions

Assign Texas WIC Card - the process of assigning a Texas WIC Card to an economic unit.

EBT Processor - the vendor responsible for mailing the Texas WIC Card, when requested through myWIC and the WIC Card Management Line.

Economic Unit - all persons, related and/or unrelated, living together in the same dwelling, except in the following special situations: pregnant woman, infants/children placed through Department of Family Protective Services (DFPS); e.g., foster/kinship and individuals who qualify as a separate economic unit.

Electronic Benefit Account (EBA) - the account where food benefits are being held for redemption.

Texas WIC

Health and Human Services Commission

Effective April 1, 2026

Policy CS:25.0(eWIC)

WIC Card Management Line - an interactive voice response system where clients can manage the Texas WIC Card (set/reset the PIN, cancel/replace the card), obtain food benefit balance, and speak to a customer service associate.

Procedures

- I. LAs must ensure each Texas WIC Card received is accounted for and kept in a secure area at each clinic/LA before a Texas WIC Card or replacement card is assigned (refer to Policies [CS:05.0](#), [CS:26.0](#)).
- II. The applicant/participant/parent/guardian/caretaker must present appropriate identification as stated in Policy [CS:05.0](#).
- III. When the applicant/participant/parent/guardian/caretaker has been determined eligible the staff must:
 - A. Upload food benefits to the Economic Unit EBA. The MIS will aggregate food benefits for all participants within an economic unit and will not allow issuance for past benefit months.
 - B. Assign a Texas WIC Card
 1. All initial cards will be issued in the clinic, or if requested by client by mail.
 2. Replacement cards may be issued in the clinic, mailed by the EBT Processor, or if requested by client by mail (refer to CS:36.0, effective April 1, 2026).
 - C. Signature for Texas WIC Card
 1. Signature is required in the MIS when receiving the card in person.
 2. When a signature is not captured, staff must select the reason in the MIS.
 - D. Inform the participant/parent/guardian/caretaker to assign a PIN through myWIC or WIC Card Management Line prior to shopping at a grocery store.

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective April 1, 2026

Policy CS:25.0(eWIC)

- E. Offer a hard copy of the shopping list and/or assist the participant with viewing food benefits in myWIC.
- F. Provide the Your Guide to Texas WIC booklet, (stock #133) that explains information about the Texas WIC Card. The booklet may also be provided at subsequent visits as needed. Only one booklet is required as long as the family is on WIC, even when there is a break in service.